AI that works: build your assistant

0. Install

Go to **claude.com/code**. Copy the install command for your computer, paste it in your terminal (Mac: Terminal · Windows: PowerShell), press Enter. Then type `claude` and sign in.

1. A home

Folder on your Desktop called `assistant`. Open a terminal there. Type `claude`.

> *What can you do on this computer?*

> *Make two folders here: projects and out.*

2. Memory

> *Create CLAUDE.md in this folder. Who I am: ___. My work: every week I ___. How I like things: short answers, plain language, ask before anything big. Rules: only work inside this folder, save what you make to `out`, ask before deleting. When I say "remember", add it here.*

Quit (`/exit`), start `claude` again, ask what it knows about you.

3. Real work

Drag a **copy** of a real file in. Pick one. Say: **"Make a folder in projects for this job, move my file there, then:"**

- **Video** (30 s from your phone): cut the dead air, add a title, export vertical for Instagram. Use ffmpeg.
- **Inbox:** connect to my email over IMAP, find last month's invoices and receipts, one spreadsheet: date, who, amount, VAT, business or personal.
- **Meeting notes:** summary, decisions, action items with owner and date, follow-up email.
- **Any CSV:** one-page weekly report as a PDF, two charts, the three numbers that changed most.
- **Receipts:** one expense report: date, shop, what, total, VAT. Total at the bottom.
- **Blog post:** a LinkedIn post, three tweets and a newsletter blurb, in my voice.
- **Contract PDF:** plain-language summary, what I'm committing to, anything risky.
- **Research:** compare ___, ___ and ___: a table and a one-page PDF with sources.
- **Website:** build me a one-page personal website from my CLAUDE.md and open it in my browser.
- **Brainstorm:** 20 ways to ___, then pick the best three and tell me why.

How to ask: what you want, where the files are, what done looks like. Stuck? "Ask me questions before you start." Big job? "Show me the plan first."

Say what to change. When it's right: **"remember that."** It may ask to install free tools (ffmpeg, Python): read what it wants, then say yes.

No file? Say: **"Download practice-kit.zip from github.com/prasann16/ai-that-works-workshop and unzip it here."**

4. A skill

> *Turn what we just did into a skill called ___.*

> *Run the ___ skill on `___`.*

5. A heartbeat

> *Every weekday at 8am, write me a note in out/today.md with what's new and the one thing I said I'd do.*

6. Your pocket

Telegram → @BotFather → `/newbot` → copy the code. Then in Claude Code: `/plugin install telegram@claude-plugins-official` · `/telegram:configure <code>` · restart with `claude --channels plugin:telegram@claude-plugins-official` · text your bot, pair with `/telegram:access pair <6 letters>`. (Needs Bun, from **bun.sh**. No Bun? Claude app → Remote Control.)

Always-on, lid closed, voice notes: `curl -fsSL https://kencomputer.dev/install | bash`

Rules: copies not originals · read before you click yes · never paste a password · one folder per job · `Esc` stops it.